

Ephraim, with whom the other tribes of Israel had joined. There is no trace of any doubt of purity of descent or that they were not the genuine tribes inhabiting the northern part of Palestine. Again, his geographical allocation of the various tribes is of extreme importance. It differs to a large extent from the division found in actual history, and he takes as his eastern and western borders the Jordan and the sea (xlvi. 14 ff.). He also declares the family of Şadoķ to be the only one among the priests to whom the future guardianship of the Temple should be entrusted (xlviii. 11). This injunction is of great significance because it establishes anew, by the authority of the prophet, the unquestioned supremacy of the Şadoķite family which claims to be the descendant in a direct line from Eleazar and Pinehas. On the other hand, he suggests that the secular ruler should be 'David', i.e. a descendant of the House of David. David has thus become a symbolical name for the House of David. The Temple is to be established in the centre of Palestine, but the political supremacy is to remain with the Tribe of Judah.

Any one who studies his description of the Temple to be and the place in which it is to be erected in the future, will find that he rejects Jerusalem and selects a central spot in Palestine, which could be nothing else but Sichem or Mount Garizim. Whether that name actually occurred originally and was afterwards left out, or whether it is a mere allusion to be interpreted later on, must be left an open question. So also is the curious definition of the geographical boundaries which agree with those found in the Samaritan Hebrew Book of Joshua, of which more later on when discussing Samaritan literature. In his geographical distribution every one of the older tribes reappears, and the names of Ephraim and the Northern Tribes also occur. To the prophet Ezekiel no change had evidently taken place, and those who might then have been inhabiting Samaria were of no consequence whatsoever. This of course could only be the case if the nations mentioned in Kings and Ezra were garrisons taken from various parts of the Assyrian and Persian empires and transferred from time to time from one place to another. Altogether a careful examination of the writings of Ezekiel, and especially of the legal code with which he was acquainted and which has been subjected to special investigation to be published at another time, may point to a different conception of the home and origin of Ezekiel than has hitherto been tacitly assumed; it looks as if he were of one of the Northern Tribes.

Now the Book of Kings is recognized as being merely a summary of events which happened in Judah and Israel; for further information the reader is always referred to the Books of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah and Israel. In the same way chapter xvii of 2 Kings must also be considered as containing a summary of the events which happened in the Northern Kingdom during some length of time. Assyrian monuments mention Sargon in lieu of Shalmanasar as the king who exiled the Israelites, but though these monuments emanate from Sargon himself, the details concerning the plantations of the new peoples are nowhere clearly defined. At the same time, it must be remembered that the whole population was not carried away into captivity, a comparatively small fraction, consisting of high officials and dignitaries, together with the official representative of the priesthood, being all that went into exile. Not only did a large population remain behind, but, unless the statement in the Second Book of Chronicles xxx. 1 ff. is to be doubted, the tribal divisions were maintained in the time of Hezekiah and the Temple on Mount Garizim must have remained in existence down to the time of Josiah, since nothing is said anywhere of the destruction of this Temple, thus leaving it an open question whether it was that dedicated to Baal or whether, according to the statement of the Samaritans, it was the old Temple dedicated to the worship of the God of Israel, which Josiah destroyed.¹

On looking through the lists of the peoples who had been established in the small province of Samaria or the habitat of the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh in addition to the indigenous Israelitish population which had remained there, it must appear rather remarkable how space could have been found to settle so many nations. The lists found in 2 Kings xvii. 24 ff., and in the letter which was sent in protest to the Persian king remonstrating against Zerubbabel's attempt to rebuild the Temple in Jerusalem (Ezra iv. 7), show that not one of the names of the nations mentioned in Kings appears in the later list; even the name of the Assyrian king is entirely different, being Asenapper instead of Shalmanasar or Sargon.² Moreover, five nationalities are mentioned in Kings, whilst nine are given in Ezra, in addition to others who are simply referred to anonymously as, 'the rest

¹ 2 Kings xxiii. 19-20.

² Asenapper seems to be the popular pronunciation for the literary Ashurbanipal, 'She' being pronounced 'Se' like the Ephraimites : v. Judges xii. 6.

of the nations whom the great and noble Asenapper brought over and set in the cities of Samaria' (Ezra iv. 10). How can these differences be reconciled, and how could still larger numbers have been settled in the few towns of Samaria, always remembering that the indigenous population was still there, and how could such a change have taken place in less than 150 years? It is the second point which has first to be established before we consider the alleged plantation of the new peoples.

In the year B.C.E. 726, Hezekiah, then king of Judah, invited the Northern Tribes, now that their political existence had almost come to an end and shortly before their chief priests were carried away into exile, to join with him in celebrating the Pass-over in Jerusalem.¹ By this means he tried to reunite all the tribes, not so much under his political sway as under the religious rule of the central Temple of Jerusalem. To this invitation some of the tribes responded favourably, among them being Manasseh, Zebulun, and Asher (v. 11), as well as some of Ephraim and Issachar (v. 18). Nearly 100 years later, in the year 630, during his great War of Reformation, Josiah still met the tribes of Manasseh and Ephraim, Simeon and Naphtali, in Northern Israel.² Neither Hezekiah nor Josiah mention any heathen nations; they do not even refer to their existence, still less to their having supplanted the original Israelitish inhabitants; nor do they say that the land had become a desert. Now these nations which are mentioned under different names at different times must therefore represent, not, as has hitherto been considered, new settlements of colonists, but simply garrisons drawn from these various nations. It was a known practice of the ancient kings to settle garrisons in conquered territories, a policy followed by Egypt and Assyria, later by the Persian kings, then by Alexander, and finally by the Romans. Everywhere soldiers were drawn from distant countries and settled in various fortified camps, which were often changed when the attitude of the nations from which they had been drawn and their loyalty to their overlord had undergone serious political changes. If a province rebelled the king could not rely upon the loyalty of his troops in distant parts which were drawn from the rebellious provinces; hence the change of the garrisons and the names of the nations in the second list as far as can be ascertained. The Persian kings themselves placed Jewish and Samaritan garrisons in

¹ 2 Chron. xxx. 1 ff.

² 2 Chron. xxxiv. 6, 7.

Assuan, whilst Alexander settled Jews and Samaritans in Egypt as well as in the northern countries of Bactria; similarly the Seleucids, especially Antiochus the Great, settled Jewish garrisons in the northern provinces, as testified by Josephus.¹ This being the case, the whole situation assumes a different aspect.

The Samaritans became a political sect of Palestine, heavily garrisoned by Assyrian, and later by Persian, troops. During the period with which we are now dealing the country was for the time being under Persia, Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes being the kings mentioned.² Moreover, Samaritan tradition says that these various nationalities were slowly drafted back into Assyria and Babylon after the re-settlement of the Israelites or that portion of them which had returned from the so-called First Exile under the leadership of the High Priest Serayah, the occasion for their return being described in the Book of Kings.

The reason for the conversion of these various heathen garrisons was, according to 2 Kings xvii. 25 ff., the plague of lions which infested the country. The colonists ascribed this calamity simply to their ignorance of the worship of the god of the land, but, considering that the best part of the population were still living there, the allegation is curious; nor does it explain how the return of the priest from Babylon could banish the lions. Surely more than one priest must have been left behind who could teach them the worship of the god of the land and thus save its inhabitants from the plague. The facts as recorded in the Book of Kings are evidently greatly reduced; they are a mere summary of the events, from which the writer never expected the consequences to flow which have subsequently been derived therefrom. In the Samaritan tradition the matter assumes a totally different aspect, and all the difficulties which this obscure passage presents are easily cleared away. They state that by having carried into exile the High Priest and the priests who ministered in the Sanctuary at Beth-el, i.e. Garizim, the service of God had come to a standstill. No more sacrifices were

¹ *Antiq.* xii. 3. 3, 4 (§ 147).

² This will explain the very curious fact that the garrison of Assuan appealed to both the High Priest of Jerusalem and to the Governor of Samaria, Sanballat, to come to its assistance when the town was taken and the temple destroyed by the Egyptians. Sanballat, however, was not the spiritual head; he was probably invested with the same power of governor as that afterwards conferred upon Nehemiah.

brought and none of the ordinances kept, with the result that the curse which had been threatened in Leviticus and Deuteronomy came to pass. With the cessation of worship, drought set in, famine followed, and wild beasts overran the land. 'And if ye walk contrary unto me, and will not hearken unto me; I will bring seven times more plagues upon you according to your sins. I will also send wild beasts among you, which shall rob you of your children, and destroy your cattle, and make you few in number; and your high ways shall be desolate.'¹ This punishment had overtaken them for their sins; it was this which had brought exile upon their priests, and in this calamity were involved not only the inhabitants of the land who had strayed from the true worship of God, but the new-comers as well. It is, therefore, in the name of the whole community that the governor and garrison for the time being sent the request to the king to have the High Priest returned and the worship re-established.

The Samaritans then go on to say that the king graciously hearkened to their request, called the High Priest Serayah, and gave him permission to send out a proclamation throughout the land that all who wished to accompany him and return to their ancient homes might do so. Special note must be taken of the name of the High Priest, who is not Dositheus or Dustai, two names which occur in Jewish tradition.² Now this Serayah asked the Jews, and among them their leader Zerubbabel, to join with him in the return and the re-establishment of the Sanctuary on Mount Garizim. In this instance the invitation is just the reverse of what we read in Ezra iv. 1 ff. There the situation is that the adversaries, evidently the Samaritans, approach Zerubbabel and Joshua, the High Priest and the elders, and ask permission to join in the rebuilding of the Temple at Jerusalem.

According to Samaritan tradition the Jews refused to join with them and so caused some delay, but this was removed by the explanation of Serayah and by the disputation which followed.

In the light of history and by reason of the position which the Samaritans occupied at the Persian court and in Babylon because of their numbers, it is not unlikely that a discussion such as that fully described by them may have taken place before the Persian king, called by them Surdi. This disputation follows

¹ Lev. xxvi. 21-2.

² See my Book of Joshua.